

markets across state boundaries and nations, and are breaching new markets as we speak. By selling your products on the platform for a while, you would get to know of better markets for your products and better products for new markets.

5. Acquiring new customers

While it's true that customers may not search for your particular brand through these channels- at least, not at first- if your product category is popular enough, there would be plenty of searches for that particular category. Due to this, your product will also get listed in the search results. Acquiring new customers then becomes a distinct possibility.

6. Stocking products

Retailers like Amazon have a large number of fulfilment centres as part of their business. You could just ship all your products en masse to such retailers and they would not only store the inventory but also package it appropriately and ship it to the customers. So, no storage expenses.

Cons

1. Minimal control

The company policies of big retailers might change and administrative decisions could be taken that aren't always to the seller's advantage. What makes things worse is the fact that you have hardly any say on such matters. And even if the policies get reversed, by the time such an event come to pass, you may have lost a lot of customers and have to start from the beginning again.

2. Constricted design options

Almost all the big online retailers have template store designs which you need to adhere. It could prove restrictive as your business grows. Since all the sellers adhere to the same design template, it becomes impossible for you to distinguish yourself from the others.

Another downside is that you would have a hard time optimising for different calls to action like having an email list sign-up in different spots along a page, robbing you of opportunities to optimise.

3. Higher competition

To take advantage of the pre-existing huge marketplace, a large number of sellers put up shop in these platforms. Also, chances are high that there